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PROCEEDINGS AND DEBATES OF THE 119th CONGRESS, SECOND SESSION

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Senate

The Senate met at 4:27 p.m. and was called to order by the Honorable JIM BANKS, a Senator from the State of Indiana.

APPOINTMENT OF ACTING PRESIDENT PRO TEMPORE

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will please read a communication to the Senate from the President pro tempore (Mr. GRASSLEY).

The senior assistant legislative clerk read the following letter:

U.S. SENATE,
PRESIDENT PRO TEMPORE,
Washington, DC, January 8, 2026.

To the Senate:

Under the provisions of rule I, paragraph 3, of the Standing Rules of the Senate, I hereby appoint the Honorable JIM BANKS, a Senator from the State of Indiana, to perform the duties of the Chair.

CHUCK GRASSLEY,
President pro tempore.

Mr. BANKS thereupon assumed the Chair as Acting President pro tempore.

CONCLUSION OF MORNING BUSINESS

Ms. MURKOWSKI. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the morning hour be deemed expired.

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. Without objection, it is so ordered.

JOURNAL OF PROCEEDINGS

Ms. MURKOWSKI. I ask unanimous consent that the Journal of proceedings be approved to date.

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. Without objection, it is so ordered.

RESERVATION OF LEADER TIME

Ms. MURKOWSKI. I ask unanimous consent that the time for the two leaders be reserved for their use later in the day.

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. Without objection, it is so ordered.

MORNING BUSINESS

Ms. MURKOWSKI. I ask unanimous consent that the Senate be in a period of morning business, with Senators permitted to speak therein for up to 10 minutes each.

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. Without objection, it is so ordered.

MEASURES PLACED ON THE CALENDAR

The following bill was read the first and second times by unanimous consent, and placed on the calendar:

H.R. 6938. An act making consolidated appropriations for the fiscal year ending September 30, 2026, and for other purposes.

MEASURE PLACED ON THE CALENDAR—H.R. 6938

Ms. MURKOWSKI. Mr. President, I understand that there is a bill at the desk that is due for a second reading.

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. The Senator is correct.

The clerk will read the bill by title for the second time.

The senior assistant legislative clerk read as follows:

A bill (H.R. 6938) making consolidated appropriations for the fiscal year ending September 30, 2026, and for other purposes.

Ms. MURKOWSKI. In order to place the bill on the calendar under the provisions of rule XIV, I would object to further proceedings.

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. Objection having been heard, the bill will be placed on the calendar.

COMMERCE, JUSTICE, SCIENCE; ENERGY AND WATER DEVELOPMENT; AND INTERIOR AND ENVIRONMENT APPROPRIATIONS ACT, 2026—Motion to Proceed

Ms. MURKOWSKI. Mr. President, I move to proceed to Calendar No. 299, H.R. 6938.

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. The clerk will report the motion.

The senior assistant legislative clerk read as follows:

Motion to proceed to Calendar No. 299, H.R. 6938, a bill making consolidated appropriations for the fiscal year ending September 30, 2026, and for other purposes.

CLOTURE MOTION

Ms. MURKOWSKI. I send a cloture motion to the desk.

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. The cloture motion having been presented under rule XXII, the Chair directs the clerk to read the motion.

The senior assistant legislative clerk read as follows:

CLOTURE MOTION

We, the undersigned Senators, in accordance with the provisions of rule XXII of the Standing Rules of the Senate, do hereby move to bring to a close debate on the motion to proceed to Calendar No. 299, H.R. 6938, a bill making consolidated appropriations for fiscal year ending September 30, 2026, and for other purposes.

John Thune, Susan M. Collins, John Barrasso, Tim Sheehy, Ashley Moody, Lindsey Graham, James Lankford, Joni Ernst, John Boozman, James C. Justice, Marsha Blackburn, Pete Ricketts, Jon Husted, Tom Cotton, Dan Sullivan, Mike Rounds, Ted Budd.

ORDERS FOR MONDAY, JANUARY 12, 2026

Ms. MURKOWSKI. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that when the Senate completes its business today, it stand adjourned until 3 p.m. on Monday, January 12; that following the prayer and pledge, the Journal of proceedings be approved to date, the morning hour be deemed expired, the

● This "bullet" symbol identifies statements or insertions which are not spoken by a Member of the Senate on the floor.

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time for the two leaders be reserved for their use later in the day, morning business be closed, and the Senate resume the motion to proceed to H.R. 6938; finally, that notwithstanding rule XXII, the cloture motion with respect to the motion to proceed to H.R. 6938 ripen at 5:30 p.m.

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. Without objection, it is so ordered.

ADJOURNMENT UNTIL MONDAY, JANUARY 12, 2026, AT 3 P.M.

Ms. MURKOWSKI. Mr. President, if there is no further business to come before the Senate, I ask that it stand adjourned under the previous order.

There being no objection, the Senate, at 4:29 p.m., adjourned until Monday, January 12, 2026, at 3 p.m.

NOMINATIONS

Executive nominations received by the Senate:

IN THE AIR FORCE

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE TO THE GRADE INDICATED UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be brigadier general

COL. CHRISTINE C. PIPER

IN THE ARMY

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT IN THE RESERVE OF THE ARMY TO THE GRADE INDICATED UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be brigadier general

COL. JODI J. SMITH

IN THE MARINE CORPS

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT IN THE UNITED STATES MARINE CORPS TO THE GRADE INDICATED WHILE ASSIGNED TO A POSITION OF IMPORTANCE AND RESPONSIBILITY UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 601:

To be general

LT. GEN. FRANCIS L. DONOVAN

CONFIRMATION

Executive nomination confirmed by the Senate January 8, 2026:

THE JUDICIARY

ALEXANDER C. VAN HOOK, OF LOUISIANA, TO BE UNITED STATES DISTRICT JUDGE FOR THE WESTERN DISTRICT OF LOUISIANA.

Daily Digest

HIGHLIGHTS

See Interim Résumé of Congressional Activity for the First Session of the 119th Congress (2025).

Senate

Chamber Action

(Legislative Days of January 7, 2026 and January 8, 2026)

Routine Proceedings, pages S95–S119, S121–S122

Measures Introduced: Fifteen bills and six resolutions were introduced, as follows: S. 3596–3610, S. Res. 576–580, and S. Con. Res. 25. **Page S115**

Measures Passed:

January 6, 2021 plaque: Senate agreed to S. Res. 580, directing the Architect of the Capitol to prominently display, in a publicly accessible location in the Senate wing of the United States Capitol, a plaque honoring the members of law enforcement responding on January 6, 2021, until the plaque can be placed in its permanent location. **Pages S111–12, S118**

Southern California wildfires anniversary: Senate agreed to S. Res. 577, observing the 1-year anniversary of the 2025 Southern California wildfires. **Pages S117–118, S119**

Congratulating University of Washington Men's soccer team: Senate agreed to S. Res. 578, congratulating the University of Washington men's soccer team on winning the 2025 National Collegiate Athletic Association Division 1 Men's Soccer National Championship. **Pages S118, S119**

Social Security program: Senate agreed to S. Res. 579, affirming the importance of the Social Security program to the people of the United States and expressing the sense of the Senate that Social Security must be preserved, protected, and strengthened for current and future generations. **Pages S118, S119**

Measures Considered:

Hostilities Within or Against Venezuela: By 52 yeas to 47 nays (Vote No. 5), Senate agreed to the motion to discharge the Committee on Foreign Relations of S.J. Res. 98, to direct the removal of United States Armed Forces from hostilities within or against Venezuela that have not been authorized by Congress. **Page S100**

Commerce, Justice, Science; Energy and Water Development; and Interior and Environment Appropriations Act, 2026—Cloture: Senate began consideration of the motion to proceed to consideration of H.R. 6938, making consolidated appropriations for the fiscal year ending September 30, 2026. **Pages S119, S121**

A motion was entered to close further debate on the motion to proceed to consideration of the bill, and, in accordance with the provisions of Rule XXII of the Standing Rules of the Senate, and pursuant to the unanimous-consent agreement of Thursday, January 8, 2026, a vote on cloture will occur at 5:30 p.m., on Monday, January 12, 2026. **Pages S121–22**

A unanimous-consent agreement was reached providing that at approximately 3 p.m., on Monday, January 12, 2026, Senate resume consideration of the motion to proceed to consideration of the bill; and that notwithstanding Rule XXII, the motion to invoke cloture with respect to the motion to proceed to the bill ripen at 5:30 p.m. **Pages S121–22**

Nomination Confirmed: Senate confirmed the following nomination:

By 53 yeas to 40 nays (Vote No. EX. 6), Alexander C. Van Hook, of Louisiana, to be United States District Judge for the Western District of Louisiana. **Pages S100–09, S122**

Nominations Received: Senate received the following nominations:

1 Air Force nomination in the rank of general.
1 Army nomination in the rank of general.
1 Marine Corps nomination in the rank of general. **Page S122**

Messages from the House: **Page S114**

Measures Discharged: **Page S114**

Measures Placed on the Calendar: **Pages S114, S121**

Measures Read the First Time: Page S114

Executive Communications: Page S114

Additional Cosponsors: Pages S115–16

Statements on Introduced Bills/Resolutions: Pages S116–19

Additional Statements: Pages S113–14

Privileges of the Floor: Page S119

Record Votes: Two record votes were taken today. (Total—6) Pages S100, S109

Adjournment: Senate convened at 10 a.m. and adjourned at 4:26 p.m., and reconvened at 4:27 p.m., on the same day, and adjourned at 4:29 p.m., until 3 p.m. on Monday, January 12, 2026. (For Senate's program, see the remarks of the Acting Majority Leader in today's Record on pages S121–22.)

Committee Meetings

(Committees not listed did not meet)

No committee meetings were held.

House of Representatives

Chamber Action

Public Bills and Resolutions Introduced: 18 public bills, H.R. 6974–6991; and 4 resolutions, H.J. Res. 138; H. Con. Res. 69; and H. Res. 982–983, were introduced. Pages H251–52

Additional Cosponsors: Page H253

Reports Filed: Reports were filed today as follows:

H.R. 178, to require the Secretary of Agriculture to carry out activities to suppress wildfires, and for other purposes, with an amendment (H. Rept. 119–429, Part 1);

H.R. 179, to direct the Secretary concerned to coordinate with impacted parties when conducting a forest management activity, and for other purposes, with an amendment (H. Rept. 119–430, Part 1);

H.R. 2250, to reauthorize the National Landslide Preparedness Act, and for other purposes, with an amendment (H. Rept. 119–431, Part 1);

H.R. 435, to amend title 5, United States Code, to provide direct hire authority to appoint individuals to Federal wildland firefighting and firefighting support positions in the Forest Service or the Department of the Interior, and for other purposes (H. Rept. 119–432, Part 1);

H.R. 1110, to require the Secretary of Agriculture to develop and implement a strategy to increase opportunities to utilize livestock grazing as a means of wildfire risk reduction, with amendments (H. Rept. 119–433, Part 1);

H.R. 2405, to direct the Secretary of Agriculture and the Secretary of the Interior to carry out activities to provide for white oak restoration, and for other purposes, with an amendment (H. Rept. 119–434, Part 1); and

H.R. 839, to prohibit the implementation of a Land Protection Plan for Muleshoe National Wildlife Refuge, with an amendment (H. Rept. 119–435). Page H251

Speaker: Read a letter from the Speaker wherein he appointed Representative Wied to act as Speaker pro tempore for today. Page H137

Recess: The House recessed at 11:50 a.m. and reconvened at 12 p.m. Page H148

Order of Business—Consideration of H.R. 6938: Agreed by unanimous consent that the question of retaining a portion of the bill on H.R. 6938 may be subject to postponement, as though under clause 8 of rule 20. Pages H150–51

Recess: The House recessed at 2:05 p.m. and reconvened at 2:30 p.m. Page H209

Commerce, Justice, Science; Energy and Water Development; and Interior and Environment Appropriations Act, 2026: The House passed H.R. 6938, making consolidated appropriations for the fiscal year ending September 30, 2026, by a yea-and-nay vote of 397 yeas to 28 nays, Roll No. 7. Earlier, the House agreed to retain Divisions B and C by a yea-and-nay vote of 419 yeas to 6 nays, Roll No. 6, and to retain Division A by a yea-and-nay vote of 375 yeas to 47 nays, Roll No. 5. Pages H151–H205, H209–11

H. Res. 977, the rule providing for consideration of the bills (H.R. 4593), (H.R. 5184), and (H.R. 6938) was agreed to yesterday, January 8th.

Miccosukee Reserved Area Amendments Act—Presidential Veto: The House voted to sustain the President's veto of H.R. 504, to amend the Miccosukee Reserved Area Act to authorize the expansion of the Miccosukee Reserved Area and to

carry out activities to protect structures within the Osceola Camp from flooding, by a yea-and-nay vote of yeas to nays, Roll No. 8 (two-thirds of those present not voting to override).

Pages H208–09, H211–12

Subsequently, the veto message (H. Doc. 119–120) and the bill were referred to the Committee on Natural Resources. **Page H212**

Finish the Arkansas Valley Conduit Act: The House voted to sustain the President's veto of H.R. 131, to make certain modifications to the repayment for the Arkansas Valley Conduit in the State of Colorado, by a yea-and-nay vote of 248 yeas to 177 nays with one answering "present", Roll No. 9 (two-thirds of those present not voting to override).

Pages H205–08, H212

Subsequently, the veto message (H. Doc. 119–119) and the bill were referred to the Committee on Natural Resources. **Page H212**

Breaking the Gridlock Act: The House passed H.R. 1834, to advance policy priorities that will break the gridlock, by a yea-and-nay vote of 230 yeas to 196 nays, Roll No. 11. **Pages H212–13, H213–27**

H. Res. 780, providing for consideration of the bill (H.R. 1834) was agreed to by a yea-and-nay vote of 224 yeas to 202 nays, Roll No. 10.

Pages H212–13

Quorum Calls—Votes: Seven yea-and-nay votes developed during the proceedings of today and appear on pages H209–10, H210, H210–11, H211–12, H212, H213, and H226–27.

Adjournment: The House met at 10 a.m. and adjourned at 8:47 p.m.

Committee Meetings

MISCELLANEOUS MEASURES

Committee on Education and Workforce: Full Committee held a markup on H.R. 6359, the "Pregnant Students' Rights Act"; and H.R. 4307, the "Enhancing Detection of Human Trafficking Act". H.R. 6359 and H.R. 4307 were ordered reported, as amended.

LEGISLATIVE PROPOSALS TO SUPPORT PATIENT ACCESS TO MEDICARE SERVICES

Committee on Energy and Commerce: Subcommittee on Health held a hearing entitled "Legislative Proposals to Support Patient Access to Medicare Services". Testimony was heard from public witnesses.

MISCELLANEOUS MEASURES

Committee on the Judiciary: Full Committee held a markup on H.R. 6260, the "Keeping Violent Offenders Off Our Streets Act"; H.R. 5213, the "Keep Violent Criminals Off Our Streets Act"; H.R. 6622, the "Sunshine for Regulatory Decrees and Settlements Act of 2025"; and H.R. 2641, to amend the Illegal Immigration Reform and Immigrant Responsibility Act of 1996 to require all Federal contractors to participate in the E-Verify program. H.R. 6260, H.R. 5213, H.R. 2641, and H.R. 6622 were ordered reported, as amended.

FIX OUR FORESTS FOR AFFORDABLE AND RELIABLE WATER AND POWER SUPPLIES

Committee on Natural Resources: Subcommittee on Water, Wildlife and Fisheries held a hearing entitled "Fix Our Forests for Affordable and Reliable Water and Power Supplies". Testimony was heard from public witnesses.

CHEMISTRY COMPETITIVENESS: FUELING INNOVATION AND STREAMLINING PROCESSES TO ENSURE SAFETY AND SECURITY

Committee on Science, Space, and Technology: Full Committee held a hearing entitled "Chemistry Competitiveness: Fueling Innovation and Streamlining Processes to Ensure Safety and Security". Testimony was heard from public witnesses.

Joint Meetings

No joint committee meetings were held.

COMMITTEE MEETINGS FOR FRIDAY, JANUARY 9, 2026

(Committee meetings are open unless otherwise indicated)

Senate

No meetings/hearings scheduled.

House

No hearings are scheduled.

Interim Résumé of Congressional Activity

FIRST SESSION OF THE ONE HUNDRED NINETEENTH CONGRESS

The first table gives a comprehensive résumé of all legislative business transacted by the Senate and House. The second table accounts for all nominations submitted to the Senate by the President for Senate confirmation.

DATA ON LEGISLATIVE ACTIVITY

January 3, 2025 through January 3, 2026

	Senate	*House*	*Total*
Days in session	202	169	..
Time in session	1265 hrs., 21′	581 hrs., 59′	..
Congressional Record:			
Pages of proceedings	S8,949	H6,138	..
Extensions of Remarks	..	E1,249	..
Public bills enacted into law	24	45	..
Private bills enacted into law	..	..	..
Bills in conference	..	1	..
Measures passed, total	449	533	982
Senate bills	109	18	..
House bills	34	375	..
Senate joint resolutions	13	6	..
House joint resolutions	17	18	..
Senate concurrent resolutions	6	4	..
House concurrent resolutions	9	12	..
Simple resolutions	261	100	..
Measures reported, total	*237	419	656
Senate bills	204	..	..
House bills	5	368	..
Senate joint resolutions	..	..	..
House joint resolutions	..	2	..
Senate concurrent resolutions	1	..	..
House concurrent resolutions	..	2	..
Simple resolutions	27	47	..
Special reports	11	4	..
Conference reports	..	..	..
Measures pending on calendar	201	140	..
Measures introduced, total	4,259	8,101	12,360
Bills	3,562	6,926	..
Joint resolutions	100	135	..
Concurrent resolutions	24	67	..
Simple resolutions	573	973	..
Quorum calls	3	1	..
Yea-and-nay votes	659	276	..
Recorded votes	..	85	..
Bills vetoed	..	2	..
Vetoes overridden	..	..	..

*These figures include all measures reported, even if there was no accompanying report. A total of 98 written reports have been filed in the Senate, 423 reports have been filed in the House.

DISPOSITION OF EXECUTIVE NOMINATIONS

January 3, 2025 through January 3, 2026

Civilian nominees, totaling 568, disposed of as follows:	
Confirmed	417
Unconfirmed	4
Withdrawn	56
Returned to White House	91
Other Civilian nominees, totaling 418, disposed of as follows:	
Confirmed	291
Unconfirmed	124
Returned to White House	3
Air Force nominees, totaling 6,055, disposed of as follows:	
Confirmed	6,027
Unconfirmed	14
Withdrawn	1
Returned to White House	13
Army nominatees, totaling 8,143, disposed of as follows:	
Confirmed	6,068
Unconfirmed	1,978
Returned to White House	97
Navy nominees, totaling 5,207, disposed of as follows:	
Confirmed	5,198
Unconfirmed	5
Returned to White House	4
Marine Corps nominees, totaling 1,553, disposed of as follows:	
Confirmed	1,486
Unconfirmed	56
Returned to White House	11
Space Force nominees, total 416, disposed of as follows:	
Confirmed	414
Unconfirmed	1
Returned to White House	1

Summary

Total nominees carried over from the First Session	0
Total nominees received this Session	22,360
Total confirmed	19,901
Total unconfirmed	2,182
Total withdrawn	57
Total return to the White House	220

Next Meeting of the SENATE

3 p.m., Monday, January 12

Senate Chamber

Program for Monday: Senate will resume consideration of the motion to proceed to consideration of H.R. 6938, Commerce, Justice, Science; Energy and Water Development; and Interior and Environment Appropriations Act, 2026, and vote on the motion to invoke cloture thereon at 5:30 p.m.

Next Meeting of the HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

9 a.m., Friday, January 9

House Chamber

Program for Friday: Consideration of H.R. 5184—Affordable HOMES Act.

Extensions of Remarks, as inserted in this issue

HOUSE

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